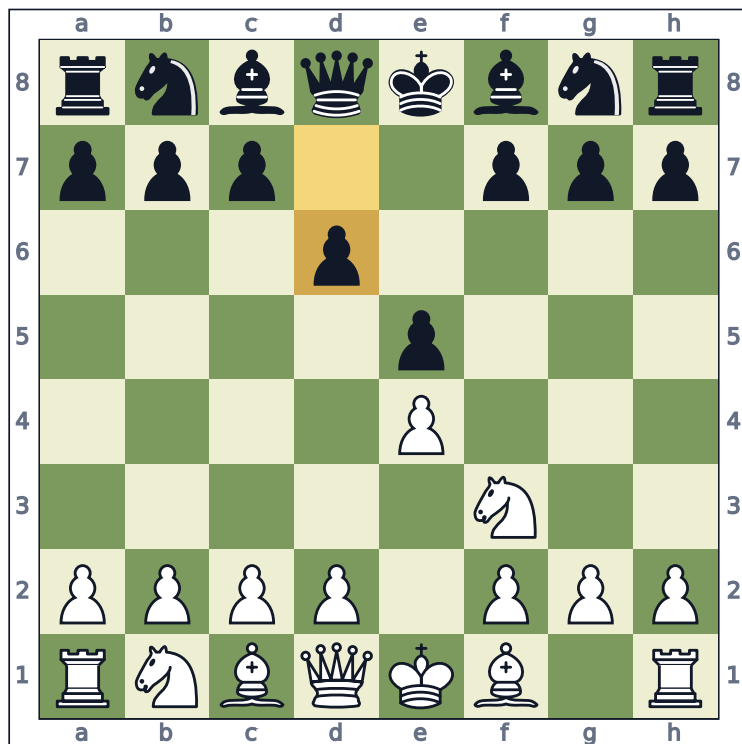


OPEN GAMES AFTER 1.E4 E5

Philidor Defense

ECO C41 | 44 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.54 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C41 covers Philidor Defense. Both sides contest the center directly, so development, king safety, and tactical accuracy become visible very early. The diagram uses the featured line Philidor Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop with threats, prepare d4 under favorable conditions, castle, and use any lead in development before it disappears.

BLACK'S GOALS

Neutralize pressure on e5, complete development, and use ...d5 when it solves the center in one move.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White's d4 and Black's ...d5 are the central freeing breaks. The f7 and f2 squares demand tactical attention.

PIECE MAP

Knights normally reach f3/c3 and f6/c6 quickly; bishops choose active diagonals according to the central tension. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Pawn grabbing and early queen moves are especially dangerous when the center can open with tempo. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Among the best openings for learning classical chess because strategic principles and tactics reinforce each other.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C41 line

This section preserves all 44 names and defining routes assigned to C41 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Philidor Defense

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6

002 Philidor Defense

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bc4

003 Philidor Defense

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4

004 Philidor Defense

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bc4 Be7

005 Philidor Defense: Albin-Blackburne Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Bg4 4. dxe5 Nd7

006 Philidor Defense: Berger Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 exd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Be7 6. Be2 O-O 7. O-O c5 8. Nf3 Nc6 9. Bg5 Be6 10. Re1

007 Philidor Defense: Bird Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 exd4 4. c3

008 Philidor Defense: Boden Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 exd4 4. Qxd4 Bd7

009 Philidor Defense: Exchange Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 exd4

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C41 line

This section preserves all 44 names and defining routes assigned to C41 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 Philidor Defense: Exchange Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 exd4 4. Nxd4

011 Philidor Defense: Exchange Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 exd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6

012 Philidor Defense: Hanham Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nd7

013 Philidor Defense: Hanham Variation, Delmar Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nd7 4. Bc4 c6 5. c3

014 Philidor Defense: Hanham Variation, Krause Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nd7 4. Bc4 c6 5. O-O

015 Philidor Defense: Hanham Variation, Schlechter Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nd7 4. Bc4 c6 5. Nc3

016 Philidor Defense: Hanham Variation, Sharp Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nd7 4. Bc4 Nb6

017 Philidor Defense: Hanham Variation, Steiner Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nd7 4. Bc4 c6 5. O-O Be7 6. dxe5

018 Philidor Defense: Hanham, Kmochno Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nd7 4. Bc4 c6 5. Ng5

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C41 line

This section preserves all 44 names and defining routes assigned to C41 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

019 Philidor Defense: Larsen Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 exd4 4. Nxd4 g6

020 Philidor Defense: Lion Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Nc3 Nbd7

021 Philidor Defense: Lion Variation, Bishop Sacrifice

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Nc3 Nbd7 5. Bc4 Be7 6. Bxf7+

022 Philidor Defense: Lion Variation, Delayed Bishop Sacrifice

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nbd7 4. Nf3 e5 5. Bc4 Be7 6. dxe5 dxe5 7. Bxf7+

023 Philidor Defense: Lion Variation, Forcing Line

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Nc3 Nbd7 5. Bc4 Be7 6. Ng5 O-O 7. Bxf7+ Rxf7 8. Ne6

024 Philidor Defense: Lion Variation, Lion's Claw, with Bc4 and h6

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Nc3 Nbd7 5. Bc4 Be7 6. O-O h6

025 Philidor Defense: Lion Variation, Lion's Claw, with Be2 and c6

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Nc3 Nbd7 5. Be2 Be7 6. O-O c6

026 Philidor Defense: Lion Variation, Shirov Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nd7 4. Nc3 Ngf6 5. g4

027 Philidor Defense: Lion Variation, Sozin Variation

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 e5 4. Nf3 Nbd7 5. Bc4 Be7 6. O-O O-O 7. Qe2 c6 8. a4 exd4

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C41 line

This section preserves all 44 names and defining routes assigned to C41 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

028 Philidor Defense: Lopez Countergambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bc4 f5

029 Philidor Defense: Lopez Countergambit, Jaenisch Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 f5 4. Bc4 exd4 5. Ng5 Nh6 6. Nxh7

030 Philidor Defense: Morphy Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4

031 Philidor Defense: Nimzowitsch Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6

032 Philidor Defense: Nimzowitsch Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. dxe5

033 Philidor Defense: Nimzowitsch Variation, Klein Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Bc4

034 Philidor Defense: Nimzowitsch Variation, Rellstab Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. dxe5 Nxe4 5. Qd5

035 Philidor Defense: Nimzowitsch Variation, Sokolsky Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. dxe5 Nxe4 5. Nbd2

036 Philidor Defense: Nimzowitsch, Larobok Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Nc3 Nbd7 5. Bc4 Be7 6. Ng5 O-O 7. Bxf7+

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C41 line

This section preserves all 44 names and defining routes assigned to C41 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

037 Philidor Defense: Nimzowitsch, Locock Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Ng5

038 Philidor Defense: Paulsen Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 exd4 4. Nxd4 d5 5. exd5

039 Philidor Defense: Philidor Countergambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 f5

040 Philidor Defense: Philidor Countergambit, Berger Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 f5 4. dxe5 fxe4 5. Ng5 d5 6. e6 Bc5 7. Nc3

041 Philidor Defense: Philidor Countergambit, Zukertort Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 f5 4. Nc3

042 Philidor Defense: Philidor Countergambit, del Rio Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 f5 4. dxe5 fxe4 5. Ng5 d5 6. e6

043 Philidor Defense: Philidor Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Bd7

044 Philidor Defense: Steinitz Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. Bc4 Be7 4. c3